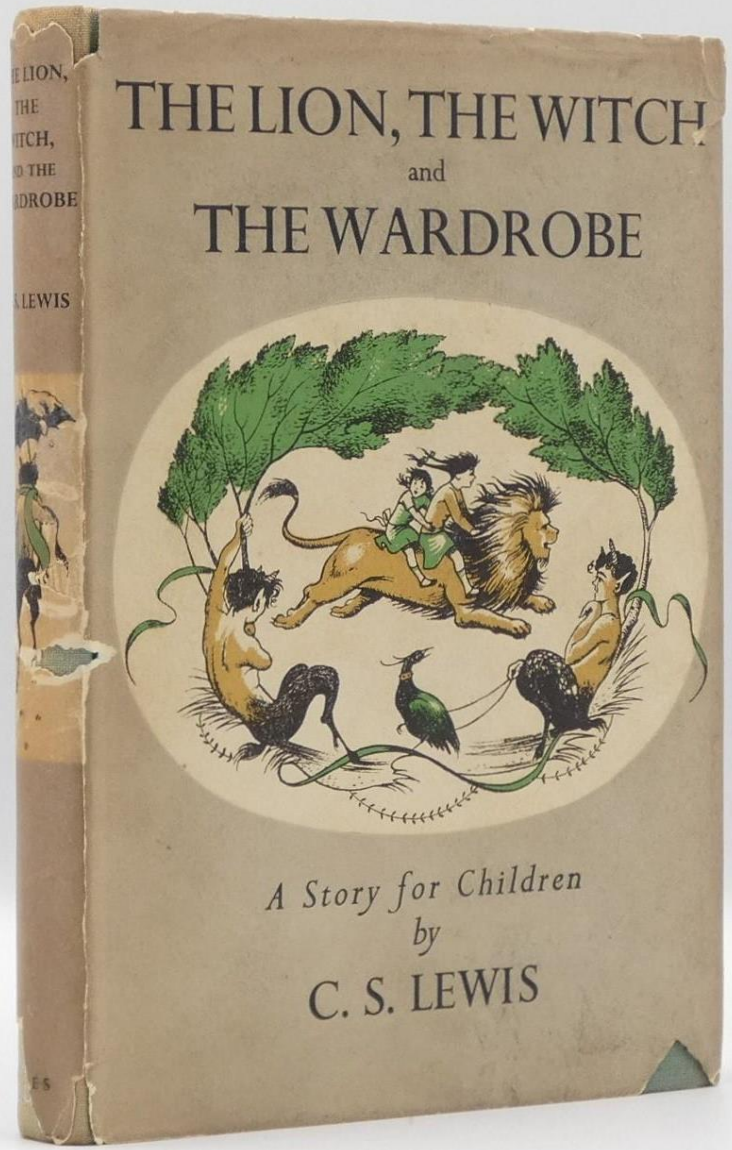
Welcome to English Literature Year 1



The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe



Written by C. S. Lewis



Genre: Fantasy and Adventure



Published in 1950



Part of The Chronicles of Narnia series

Before We Begin…

- Have you ever heard of The Lion, the Witch and the Wardrobe?
- Have you read the book or watched the film?
- What do you already know about the story?
- What do you think the title tells us about the book?
- Would you like to visit a magical world? Why or why not?
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=usEkWtuNn-w

Introduction to the Story



Four siblings discover a mysterious wardrobe.



The wardrobe leads to a magical world called Narnia.



Narnia is a land filled with talking animals and mythical creatures.



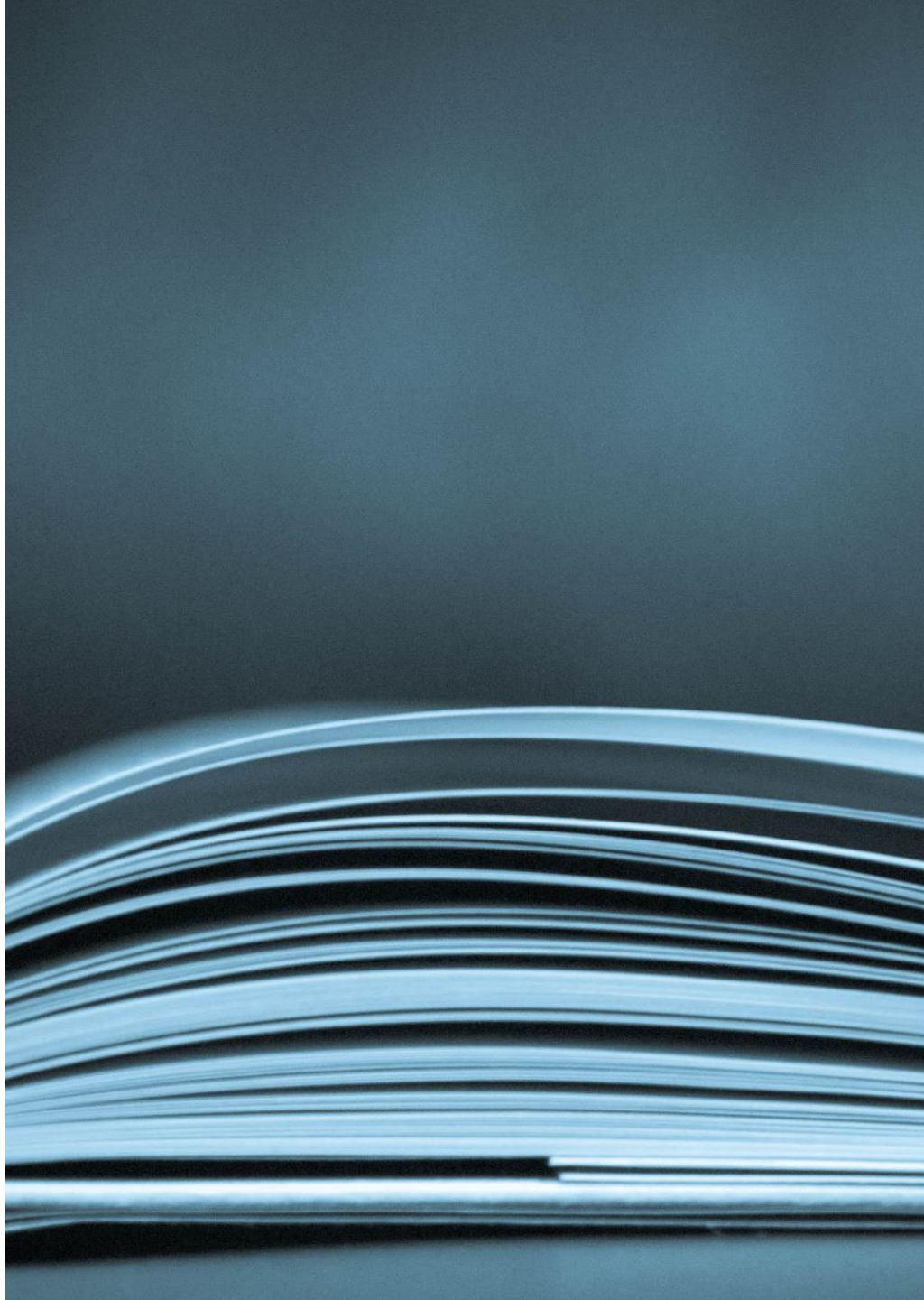
The land is under the control of the powerful White Witch.

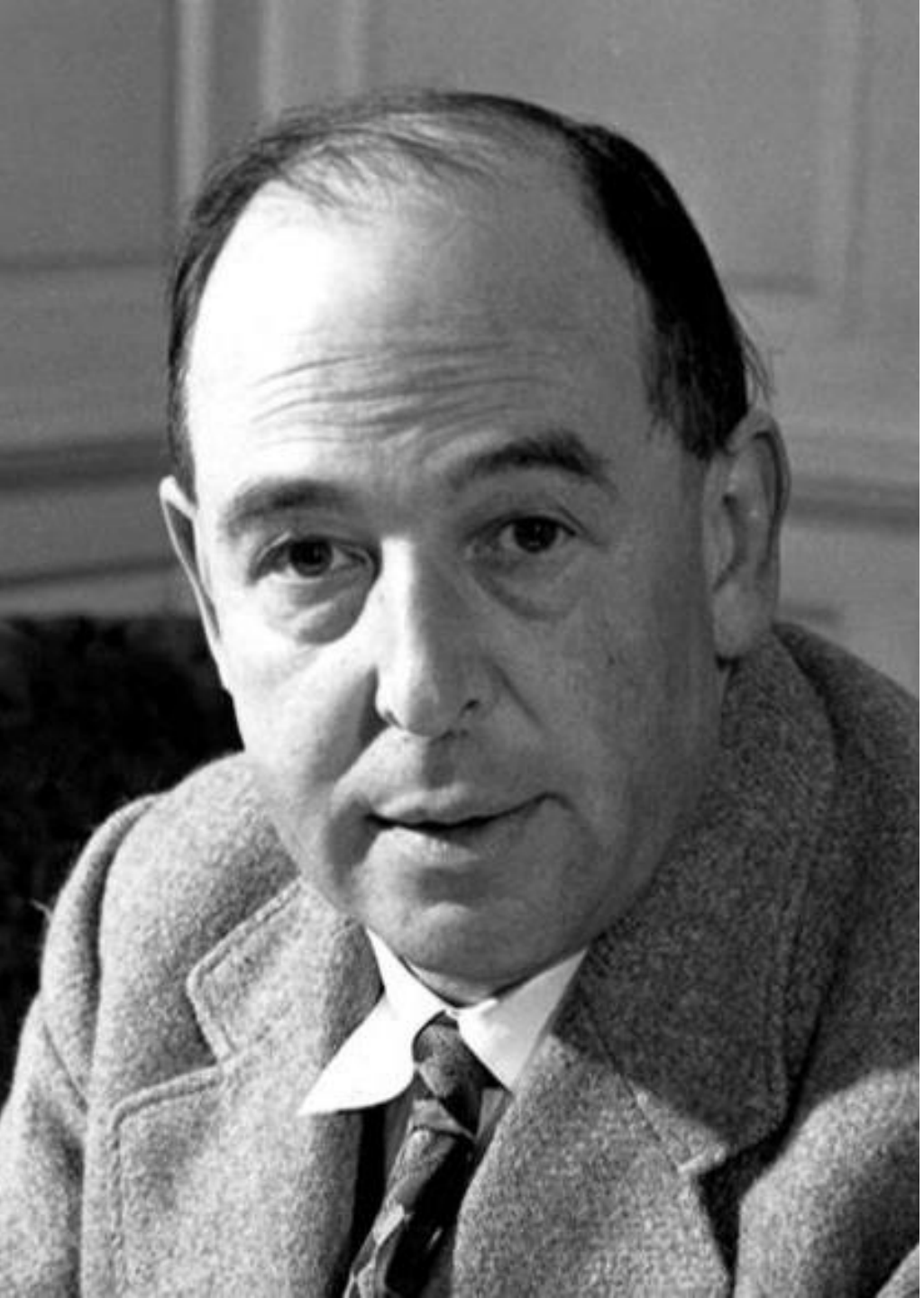


The children become involved in an adventure that will change their lives.

Can You Predict the Story?

- A blurb is a short description of a book, usually found on the back cover. It gives readers an idea of the story without revealing the ending.
- Activity: Read the blurb of the book and answer the following questions.
- Who do you think the main characters are?
- What problems might they face?
- What do you think will happen in Narnia?
- How do you think the story will end?





Meet the Author: C. S. Lewis

- Full name: Clive Staples Lewis
- Born: 1898 in Belfast, Ireland
- Died: 1963
- British and Irish writer and university professor
- Famous for The Chronicles of Narnia
- His stories often explore courage, friendship, good and evil.
- Interesting Fact: C. S. Lewis was also a close friend of J. R. R. Tolkien, the author of The Lord of the Rings.

Historical Background: World War II

- The story begins in England during World War II (1939–1945).
- Many cities were in danger of being bombed.
- Children were sent to the countryside for safety.
- The four siblings leave London and stay in a large country house.
- This is where their adventure begins.

Discussion: How would you feel if you had to leave your home and family during a war?



The Setting: Two Different Worlds

England

- During World War II
- A large country house
- An ordinary, realistic world



Narnia

- A magical land
- Talking animals and mythical creatures
- An endless winter
- Ruled by the White Witch





Literary Genre: Fantasy

- Fantasy is a type of fiction that includes magical or supernatural elements that do not exist in the real world.

Common Features of Fantasy Stories:

- Magical places and imaginary worlds
- Talking animals or mythical creatures
- Heroes and villains
- Supernatural powers
- Adventures and challenges
- Conflicts between good and evil
- **Discussion:** Can you name another fantasy book or film?

Meet the Main Characters

The Four Pevensie Children

- **Peter:** The eldest sibling, responsible and protective.
- **Susan**: Practical, thoughtful and cautious.
- **Edmund**: Sometimes selfish and easily tempted.
- **Lucy**: The youngest, curious, kind and adventurous.

Other Important Characters

- **Aslan**: A powerful and wise lion.
- **The White Witch:** The ruler who keeps Narnia in an endless winter.
- **Mr Tumnus**: A friendly faun who lives in Narnia.



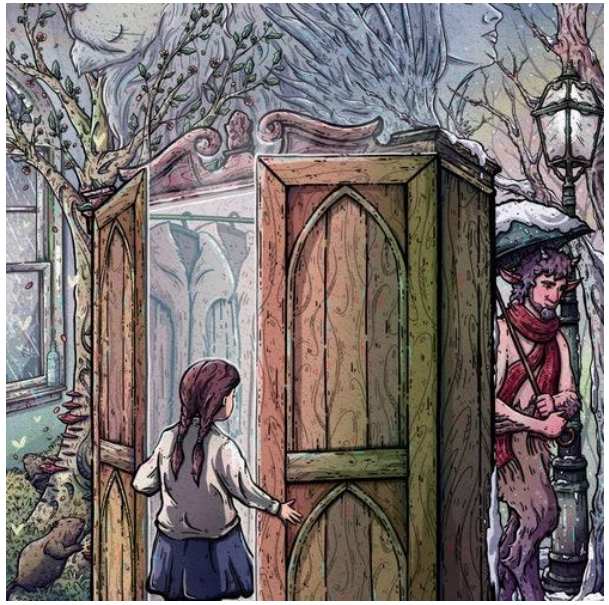
Important Vocabulary

Word	Meaning
Wardrobe	A large cupboard used for storing clothes
Evacuation	Moving people away from danger
Faun	A mythical creature, part human and part goat
Prophecy	A prediction about the future
Enchantment	A magical spell
Betrayal	Being disloyal to someone who trusts you
Sacrifice	Giving up something important for someone else
Courage	Being brave when facing danger

Important Symbols







- A symbol is an object, character or place that represents a deeper meaning.

The Wardrobe

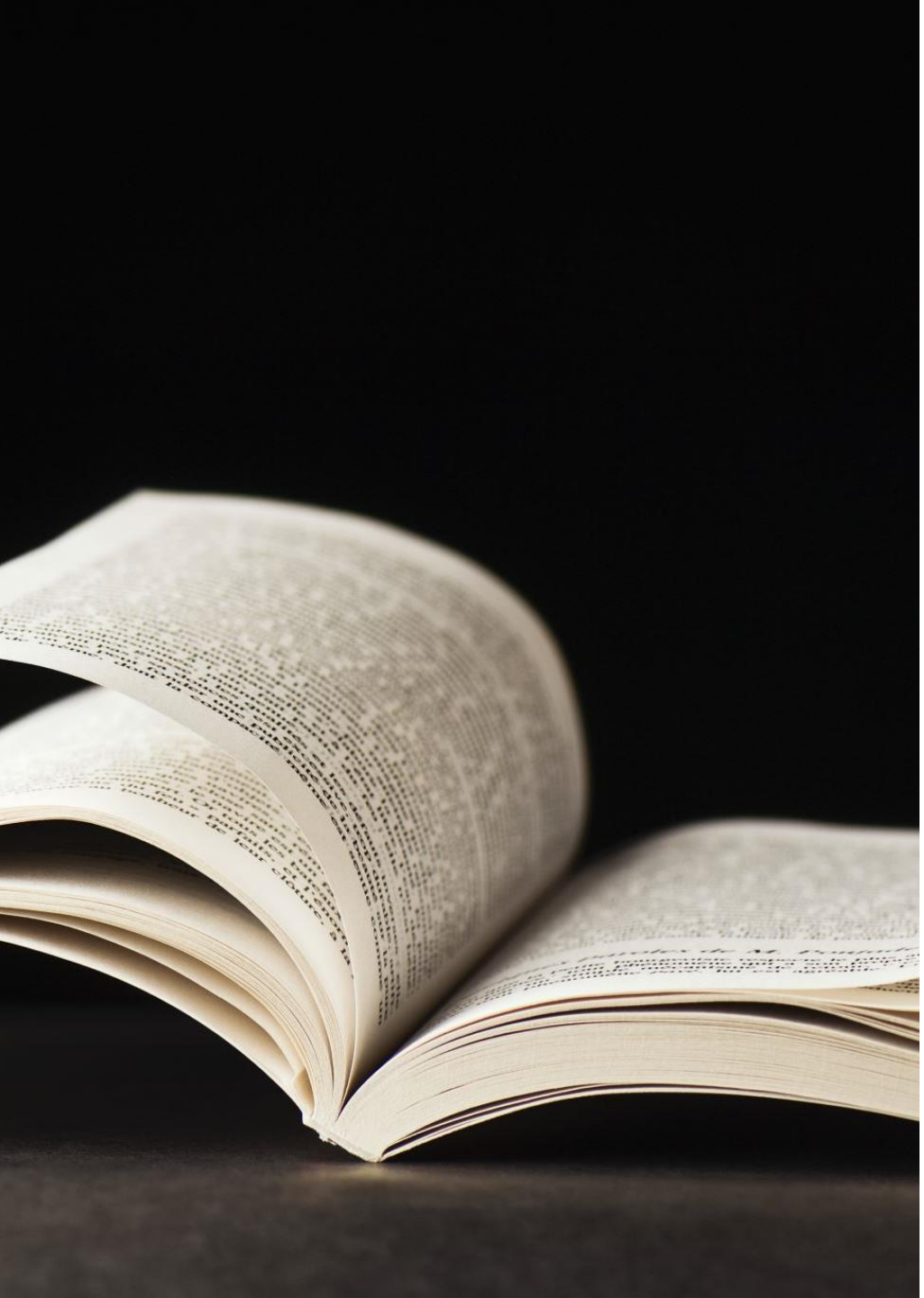
- Represents discovery and the passage from the ordinary world to a magical world.

Aslan

- Represents goodness, courage and sacrifice.

The Endless Winter

- - Represents the White Witch's control, suffering and the absence of hope.



Major Themes

- A theme is an important idea or message that a writer explores throughout a story.

Main Themes in the Novel:

- **Good vs Evil**: The struggle between good and evil forces.
- **Courage**: Facing difficulties and overcoming fear.
- **Friendship and Loyalty**: Supporting and protecting others.
- **Betrayal and Forgiveness:** Making mistakes and learning to forgive.
- **Sacrifice**: Giving up something important to help others.

Motifs in the Story

A motif is an image, idea or detail that appears repeatedly in a story and helps develop its themes.

Important Motifs:

- Winter and Spring: The movement from suffering towards hope and renewal.
- Magic: Creates mystery and changes the characters' experiences.
- Journeys: Represent adventure, discovery and personal growth.
- Choices: The decisions characters make affect themselves and others.

Creative Writing Activity

Imagine You Discover a Magical Wardrobe!

You are exploring an old house when you find a mysterious wardrobe. You open the door and discover a completely different world.

Write a short paragraph describing:

- What you see when you enter
- What the magical world looks like
- How you feel
- Who or what you meet
- What you decide to do next
- Remember: Use descriptive adjectives and your imagination!



Introduction to Book Reviews



What Is a Book Review?

- A book review is a piece of writing in which you describe and evaluate a book and share your opinion about it.

•A Good Book Review Includes:

- Introduction: Title, author and genre.
- Plot Summary: What the story is about, without revealing the ending.
- Characters: The main characters and their personalities.
- Themes: Important messages and ideas in the story.
- Personal Opinion: What you liked or disliked and why.
- Recommendation: Would you recommend the book to others?

•Task: As we read the novel, make notes about the characters, events and themes to help you write your review later.

Before We Start Reading...

- Let's Think!
  - What are your expectations of the book?
  - Which character are you most interested in?
  - What do you think makes a good fantasy story?
  - What lessons do you think the characters might learn?

- Final Question: If you could enter Narnia, what would you like to discover?

